Acceptable Use Policy

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Owner: Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) | Approved by: Executive Risk Committee

Supersedes: Remote Work Guidelines 2024 (HR-IT-RW-2024) | Classification: Internal

1. Purpose

This policy explains how Brightwick devices, accounts, networks and data may be used. It protects employees, customers and the company from security, legal and reputational harm.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors and agency staff, and to every device or account used for Brightwick work. It replaces the Remote Work Guidelines 2024 in full, including their rules on personal devices.

3. Company devices

Company laptops, phones and store devices are provided for business use. Limited personal use, such as reading news during a break, is allowed as long as it does not interfere with work, break the law or break any other Brightwick policy. The following are never allowed on company devices:

- installing software from outside the Software Portal without approval,
- disabling or bypassing endpoint security, the firewall or the VPN,
- mining cryptocurrency or running personal servers,
- storing illegal, offensive or pirated content,
- letting family members or anyone else use the device.

4. Personal devices

Device	Allowed use	Conditions
Personal phone	Company email and chat	Must be enrolled in Brightwick Mobile; see KB-1031
Personal laptop or tablet	None, apart from internet access on BW-Guest	No access to company email, files or applications
Personal USB drive	None	USB storage is blocked on company laptops

This replaces the earlier rule in the Remote Work Guidelines 2024 that allowed personal laptops to open webmail and the HR portal in a browser. That rule no longer applies.

5. Email and messaging

- Use your company account only for Brightwick business.
- Do not set up automatic forwarding of company email to personal email accounts.
- Never send Restricted information by email or chat.
- Report suspicious emails with the Report Phish button.

6. Internet use

Internet access is filtered. Categories such as gambling, adult content, malware and anonymising proxies are blocked. If a site you need for work is blocked, request a review through ServicePoint. Do not try to get around the filter.

7. Generative AI tools

Brightwick Assistant is the company's approved generative AI tool, and it is configured so that company data is not used to train external models. When using any public generative AI tool that is not Brightwick Assistant:

- do not enter Confidential or Restricted information, including customer data, employee data or source code,
- treat the answers as unverified, and check them before using them in your work,
- do not use AI tools to make decisions about individual employees or customers.

8. Social media

Do not share Internal, Confidential or Restricted information on social media. Only authorised spokespeople may comment on behalf of Brightwick. Report posts that leak company information to Internal Communications.

9. Remote work and travel

- When working away from Brightwick locations, connect to the BrightSecure VPN before accessing internal systems. Contractors use Brightwick Remote Workspace instead.
- Public Wi-Fi may only be used with the VPN connected.
- Do not work on Confidential or Restricted information where others can see your screen, for example on trains or in cafés.
- Before travelling with a company laptop to a country on the Security team's high-risk list, request a loaner laptop through ServicePoint at least 10 business days before you leave.

10. Monitoring

Brightwick monitors the use of its systems, networks and accounts to protect security and meet legal duties. Monitoring is proportionate and follows applicable privacy law. Personal phones enrolled in Brightwick Mobile are monitored only for the company data inside the managed apps.

11. Reporting and consequences

Report breaches of this policy to your manager or the IT Service Desk. Breaches may lead to removal of access, disciplinary action up to and including dismissal, or the end of a contract.